



1. PAUL JOHN

This exclusive single cask two-part whiskey was released as Alter-Ego. It was created for the Single Malt Amateur Club. Only 276 bottles of Alter and 120 bottles of Ego were launched

2. With close to 40,000 casks, the whiskey brand cherry-picks certain casks based on their quality, and these are then sold as single casks as part of their programme

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2025, halves import tariff on Scotch from 150% to 75% upon ratification, with a phased reduction to 40% over the next decade. The FTA will open the gates wider for Scotch.

D'Souza of Paul John acknowledges the hurdles around cask programmes, from limited awareness to price-conscious buyers. With a long-term vision, he and his team are working to change that, beginning at their visitor centre in Goa. Here, newcomers and seasoned drinkers alike can explore an array of tasting experiences. Diageo India is charting a global-first initiative with The Good Craft Co Flavour Lab, to build a direct-to-consumer ecosystem. With an immersive platform, it anchors its efforts on education, advocacy,

and appreciation for India's craft spirits community.

The rise of private cask ownership within India's single malt segment is quietly gaining traction. Diageo India and Paul John pursue distinct approaches in how they curate their single-cask programmes, which shape the experience, the audience, and the narrative in markedly different ways.

Yet, the outcome is undeniable: both are broadening access to bespoke Indian single malts, positioning them as coveted assets for seasoned connoisseurs and an aspirational gateway for a new generation of enthusiasts, both at home and globally. **BT**

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